Novel Prep English Diagnostic Assessment

Grades 9–11 · Reading, Language & Writing · 100 points

Name:		Date:	
Grade:		School:	
Start time:		Finish time:	

Test Overview

Part	Questions	Points	Suggested time
I. Reading	1–12	24	20 minutes
II. Language & Vocabulary	13–40	56	15 minutes
III. Writing	1 essay	20	25 minutes
Total	40 + essay	**100**	About 60-80 minutes

Directions

- Each multiple-choice question is worth 2 points. Circle the letter of the best answer.
- Read each passage carefully. You may underline and take notes on the passages.
- Write the time when you start and finish each passage in the spaces provided.
- Answer every question. There is no penalty for guessing.
- Do not use a dictionary, phone, translator, or AI tool.

Part I · Reading

12 questions × 2 points = 24 points. Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow.

Passage 1 *Informational Text: Science*

> About 86 percent of the total weight of a glass of milk is water. The remaining 14 percent is a combination of nutritious solids suspended in the water. The solids consist of milk sugar, fat, protein, minerals, and vitamins.
>
> Milk is a unique food because it meets most of the body's requirements for growth and health. It is especially rich in Vitamins A and B and the minerals calcium and phosphorus, none of which can be easily obtained from other foods. These substances are essential for normal development and maintenance of healthy bones and teeth.
>
> In spite of this, it is fortunate for us that we do not have to live on milk alone, as it does not supply us with the iron we need to prevent anemia. In its natural state, milk also lacks Vitamin D, whose production within the body can be stimulated by sunshine, and the commercial preparation of milk eliminates its Vitamin C. It is therefore necessary to get these essential vitamins and minerals from other food sources.

1. The largest part of milk is

- **A.** water.
- **B.** sugar.
- **C.** vitamins.
- **D.** minerals.

2. According to the passage, milk is an especially important food because

- **A.** it costs less than most other drinks people buy.
- **B.** it can be found easily in almost every store.
- **C.** it contains more protein than any other food.
- **D.** several of its nutrients are hard to get from other foods.

3. Milk does **not** contain

- **A.** phosphorus.
- **B.** iron.
- **C.** fat.
- **D.** Vitamin A.

4. Which choice best describes how the passage is organized?

- **A.** It describes what milk contains, explains its value, then notes what it lacks.
- **B.** It explains step by step how milk travels from the farm to the table.
- **C.** It compares milk with other foods to prove that milk is the best one.
- **D.** It traces the history of how milk became a popular food around the world.

Passage 2 *Persuasive Speech*

The following speech was given by a resident at a city council meeting.

> "I stand before you today not to voice a complaint, but to plead for justice. I implore the council to reconsider the recent decision to rebuild my neighborhood, the area surrounding the North Freeway. In recent legislation, **our friends** on the city council described this area as dilapidated and, therefore, a threat to the local economy. Council members determined that these homes should be replaced with newer construction simply because the area is unattractive to tourists.
>
> In response to this decision, I would like to point out that the houses in this neighborhood are homes to several families. These families—these citizens—do not wish to leave the homes they cherish. Though one house may be more attractive than another, no home that houses a comfortable, tax-paying family should be deemed a threat to the economy. This is not *Animal Farm*, in which George Orwell wrote 'all animals are equal, but some animals are more equal than others.' I remind the council that the citizens of this neighborhood are already equal. Replacing older houses with newer ones will not make the area 'more equal' than it currently is.
>
> Today, I request that the council reconsider the justification of rebuilding the North Freeway community. This project will prove **a great injustice** to the citizens of this neighborhood. The families who live in these homes have the same rights as other citizens in this city and do not deserve to be forced out of their homes."

5. The speaker's reference to "**our friends**" is ironic because

- **A.** the speaker has never met any members of the city council.
- **B.** most people in the audience know the speaker personally.
- **C.** the council members have acted against the speaker's neighborhood.
- **D.** the speaker's real friends in the audience are not on the council.

6. The speech mentions an idea from the novel *Animal Farm* in order to show that

- **A.** educated citizens can solve the city's construction problems.
- **B.** no neighborhood or group of citizens is worth more than another.
- **C.** some citizens have only a small stake in city government.
- **D.** the speaker's own rights as a citizen have been violated.

7. Why does the speaker claim that the project would be "**a great injustice**"?

- **A.** The U.S. Constitution clearly prohibits the city's plan.
- **B.** The families would be glad to leave the run-down area.
- **C.** Tourists only want to visit the most attractive areas.
- **D.** The residents are equal citizens who should keep their homes.

8. Which of the following is the main purpose of this speech?

- **A.** to persuade residents of one area to support the council
- **B.** to prove that the city council cares mainly about tourism
- **C.** to convince the council that a planned project is unfair
- **D.** to present a new building plan to the city council

Passage 3 *Argumentative Text: History of Science*

> Much attention and envy are always directed toward the unusual genius. Countless biographies and biographical films chronicle a modern world shaped by the blinding innovations of restless mavericks. For example, Alexander Fleming discovered the antibacterial agent in penicillin by accidentally allowing a culture plate to be contaminated by mold, but he is hailed for his insight and originality.
>
> For every Fleming, however, there is always a Jonas Salk. Salk was ridiculed by much of the scientific community for his use of other scientists' research and mundane scientific procedure in his successful quest to develop a polio vaccine. Nevertheless, Salk did develop the vaccine for a twentieth-century plague. While the restless genius may sometimes catch lightning in a bottle, it is the unheralded and methodical scholar who often carries the bulk of the scientific workload.

9. According to the passage, what is the main reason Salk's work was ridiculed by other scientists?

- **A.** Salk borrowed heavily from the work of Alexander Fleming.
- **B.** Salk was unable to master standard scientific procedure.
- **C.** The polio vaccine was later shown to be another's work.
- **D.** Salk's work did not rely mainly on independent innovation.

10. The author mentions biographies and biographical films in the second sentence in order to

- **A.** show that most people have no interest in scientific discovery.
- **B.** show how curious people are about individualistic thinkers.
- **C.** describe the controversy around the discovery of penicillin.
- **D.** argue that Jonas Salk deserves a biography of his own.

11. The author suggests that other scientists initially viewed Salk's work as

- **A.** brilliant.
- **B.** innovative.
- **C.** prosaic.
- **D.** complex.

12. Which of the following best describes the author's main purpose in writing this passage?

- **A.** to show that not all discoveries come from unconventional geniuses
- **B.** to argue that one method of discovery is superior to all others
- **C.** to describe the dramatic discovery of penicillin by Fleming
- **D.** to recommend more funding for scientists who work like Salk

Part II · Language & Vocabulary

28 questions × 2 points = 56 points. Choose the best answer. "NO CHANGE" means the original wording is best.

Grammar, Usage & Punctuation

13. Which of the following is a complete sentence?

- **A.** The library closes early on Fridays.
- **B.** Because the library closes early on Fridays.
- **C.** Closing early on Fridays.
- **D.** Which closes early on Fridays.

14. *Although the test was difficult, most students finished early, and several earned perfect scores.* What type of sentence is this?

- **A.** simple
- **B.** compound
- **C.** complex
- **D.** compound-complex

15. Which choice best combines these sentences? *The storm knocked out the power. We lit candles.*

- **A.** The storm knocked out the power, we lit candles.
- **B.** The storm knocked out the power we lit candles.
- **C.** When the storm knocked out the power, we lit candles.
- **D.** The storm knocking out the power, and we lit candles.

16. *Maya loves winter sports. Especially skiing and ice skating.* What is the best way to fix this?

- **A.** NO CHANGE
- **B.** sports, especially skiing
- **C.** sports; especially skiing
- **D.** sports. And especially skiing

17. *The results were surprising, however, the scientists repeated the experiment.* What is the best revision?

- **A.** NO CHANGE
- **B.** surprising, however the scientists
- **C.** surprising however the scientists
- **D.** surprising; however, the scientists

18. *Hoping to win the science fair,* _____

- **A.** the project took Nia three weeks.
- **B.** Nia's project took three weeks.
- **C.** three weeks were spent on the project.
- **D.** Nia spent three weeks on her project.

19. *The new library is bright, spacious, and has comfort.* What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. and it is comfortable to be in
C. and comfortable
D. and comforting you

20. Which sentence is correct?

A. Each of the students have a locker.
B. Each of the students are having a locker.
C. Each of the students has a locker.
D. Each of the students have lockers.

21. The box of old photographs _____ in the attic.

A. is
B. were
C. are
D. have been

22. *When the bell rang, the students grab their backpacks and rushed outside.* What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. are grabbing
C. will grab
D. grabbed

23. We will start the game as soon as everyone _____.

A. will arrive
B. arrives
C. arrived
D. had arrived

24. *Me and Kevin are going to the library after school.* What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. I and Kevin's
C. Kevin and me
D. Kevin and I

25. The museum changed _____ hours for the holiday.

A. their
B. it's
C. its
D. they're

26. After the long hike, the lemonade tasted _____.

A. sweet
B. sweetly
C. sweeter than
D. sweetest

27. Which sentence is correct?

- **A.** I can hardly wait for summer.
- **B.** I can't hardly wait for summer.
- **C.** I can't barely wait for summer.
- **D.** I can't hardly not wait for summer.

28. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- **A.** After the game ended, the fans rushed onto the field.
- **B.** After the game ended the fans rushed onto the field.
- **C.** After the game, ended the fans rushed onto the field.
- **D.** After, the game ended the fans rushed onto the field.

29. *I wanted to go to the concert but I had too much homework.* What is the best revision?

- **A.** NO CHANGE
- **B.** concert, but I had
- **C.** concert but, I had
- **D.** concert; but, I had

30. *Mount Everest which is the tallest mountain on Earth attracts hundreds of climbers every year.* What is the best revision?

- **A.** NO CHANGE
- **B.** Mount Everest which is the tallest mountain on Earth, attracts
- **C.** Mount Everest, which is the tallest mountain on Earth attracts
- **D.** Mount Everest, which is the tallest mountain on Earth, attracts

31. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- **A.** The phone that I lost last week was found in the car.
- **B.** The phone, that I lost last week, was found in the car.
- **C.** The phone that I lost, last week was found in the car.
- **D.** The phone that, I lost last week was found in the car.

32. *The dogs owner apologized.* (There is one dog.) What is the best revision?

- **A.** NO CHANGE
- **B.** dog's
- **C.** dogs'
- **D.** dogs's

33. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- **A.** "I'll meet you at noon", she said.
- **B.** "I'll meet you at noon," she said.
- **C.** "I'll meet you at noon" she said.
- **D.** "I'll meet you at noon," She said.

34. Which quotation is cited correctly in MLA format?

- **A.** "If people were like rain, I was like drizzle and she was a hurricane." (Green, page 88)
- **B.** "If people were like rain, I was like drizzle and she was a hurricane" (Green, 88).
- **C.** "If people were like rain, I was like drizzle and she was a hurricane" (Green 88).
- **D.** "If people were like rain, I was like drizzle and she was a hurricane" (Green page 88).

35. Choose the best word or words to join the thoughts together. *It rained all morning; _____ the game was postponed.*

A. therefore,
B. however,
C. for example,
D. nevertheless,

36. Choose the best word or words to join the thoughts together. *The movie had great reviews. _____ I found it boring.*

A. Therefore,
B. However,
C. For example,
D. Similarly,

Vocabulary

Questions 37–38: Choose the **synonym** (the word closest in meaning) of the word in capital letters.

37. Smartphones have become so **UBIQUITOUS** that it is now rare to see a teenager without one.

A. temporary
B. widespread
C. expensive
D. dangerous

38. Before signing the contract, the lawyer took time to **SCRUTINIZE** every clause for hidden fees.

A. dismiss
B. imitate
C. examine
D. conceal

Questions 39–40: Choose the **antonym** (the word most nearly opposite in meaning) of the word in capital letters.

39. Charles Dickens was a **PROLIFIC** writer, publishing fifteen novels along with hundreds of stories and articles.

A. influential
B. experienced
C. enthusiastic
D. unproductive

40. In her **CANDID** interview, the athlete openly discussed the mistakes that cost her team the championship.

A. evasive
B. honest
C. modest
D. formal

Part III · Writing

Argumentative essay · 20 points · 30 minutes

> AI can already do tasks once done by customer service workers, translators, and even programmers. Supporters say it will create new kinds of jobs, as past technologies did. Critics warn that this change is happening faster than workers can adapt.

Prompt: *Will AI do more good than harm to the future job market? Develop an argument using reasoning and specific examples, and explain why the opposing view is less convincing.*

Your essay will be scored on:

Criterion	Points	What a strong essay does
Claim & Position	4	Takes a clear side that answers the question
Reasons & Evidence	6	Gives 2–3 reasons, each with a specific example that is explained
Counterargument	4	States the other side fairly and explains why it is weaker
Organization	3	Introduction, body paragraphs, conclusion, and clear transitions
Language & Conventions	3	Varied sentences, precise words, few grammar errors

Aim for 4–5 paragraphs (about 350–500 words).

Essay

End of test. Check your answers if you have time left.